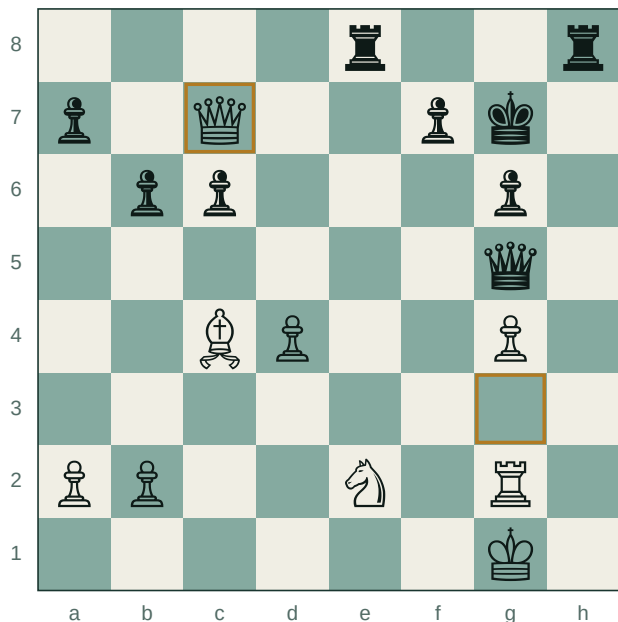


Deflection tactics: Black, move 35

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 35.Qc7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35...Qe3+ 36. Rf2 Rh1+ 37. Kxh1 Qxf2 38. Qxf7+ Qxf7

35...Qe3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From e3 it attacks king on g1 and knight on e2. Recorded reply: **36.Rf2**.

36...Rh1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **37.Kxh1**.

37...Qxf2 The queen captures the rook on f2. The changed line means the rook on e8 attacks the knight on e2. Recorded reply: **38.Qxf7+**.

38...Qxf7 The queen captures the queen on f7.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8:** the balance goes from +0 to +8. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on c7 and bishop on c4. Check for tactical protection.